

ÖTZI THE ICEMAN

One fall day in 1991, two Germans hiking in the Alps stumbled across a human head and torso emerging from the melting ice. That body turned out to be 5,300 years old. Along with tools found at the same site, the frozen body was so well preserved that archaeologists have pieced together clues to bring his story to life and solve the mystery surrounding his violent death.



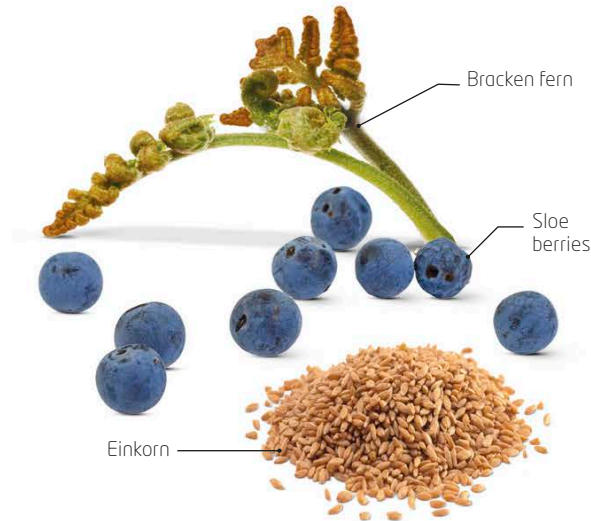
Site of Ötzi's discovery

ITALY

Mediterranean Sea

The Iceman's grave

Hikers found the Iceman on the Italian-Austrian border. His last days had taken him from the subalpine region of the Ötztal Alps and up to the Tisenjoch Pass.



The last supper

By examining the contents of the Iceman's stomach, scientists discovered he ate ibex (wild goat) for his last meal. His diet also consisted of einkorn (an early type of wheat), venison, and sloe berries. Traces of bracken fern were also found in his stomach, which he may have taken as medicine.

The Copper Age

The first of the metal ages is known as the Copper Age. This was a time when people began to extract and smelt metal to mold into tools rather than using stone. Remains of copper tools and arrow heads have been found in the region where the Iceman died.



Ötzi's autopsy

Archaeologists studying the body revealed it to be of a 45-year-old man with brown hair, who weighed about 134 lb (61 kg). Forensic examinations also suggest that he was in poor health, that he suffered from sore joints, and that he bled to death. Due to the pollen of a hop hornbeam tree found on his body, scientists could also tell that he died in early summer.

